

PACE Study: Information on the ESM part

What is the Experience-Sampling Method (ESM) and why do we use it?

- The Experience-Sampling Method (ESM) is a research technique to collect data on individuals' experiences and behaviors as they unfold in their everyday lives.
- This allows us to study how your thoughts, feelings, and behaviors change across situations and time, and the extent to which situational characteristics may be linked to these patterns.
- To this end, we are asking you several questions about your current situation as well as your momentary experiences and behaviors.
- **Importantly, all ESM questions refer to the moment just before you started filling out the survey.** That is, in the ESM surveys, we are *not* asking you about your experience with filling out the survey itself.

When will I receive the ESM surveys and how much time do I have to complete them?

- You were randomly assigned to a condition in which you receive **8 short surveys per day for the next 14 days**.
- The surveys will be sent at random times each day, within a **14-hour window** starting from your preferred start time.
- In the last survey of the day, you will have the option of indicating a unique start time for the next day (i.e., this will only apply to the following day). If you would like to modify the general start times that you indicated in the baseline-survey, please contact the study team at psy.dynamics@hu-berlin.de
- **You must start the survey within 30 minutes of receiving the invitation.**
- However, please **complete the survey in one sitting once you have started**, as the survey will expire if you remain inactive.

How to answer questions about your situation for which you could personalize the response options?

- In the baseline survey, you could **personalize** the response options to the ESM questions about your current situation (e.g., by adding specific places that are important in your daily life).
- The instructions on how to select your responses to these personalized questions are repeated below for each question.

Place: Just now, where were you?

- Please select a **single response option that best and most specifically** describes the place you just were before you started filling out the survey. For example, if you were at home, please select this response option even if your home is on campus and thus the response option "at campus (not in class)" technically also applies.
- **Implications for the personalized response options:** If a personalized response option applies such that you were in your bedroom and you added "bedroom" to the options, please select this option and not the broader category we already provided (which would be "at home" in this example).

Activity: Just now, what were you doing? Please select all that apply.

- A single activity can fall into multiple categories, which may depend on the context in your daily life. For example, "cooking" might be considered a hobby (i.e., "active leisure"), something you do with others (i.e., "social"), or a "chore".
- **You can decide which response option(s) best describe the activity** you were doing just before you started filling out the survey. But please **select all response options that apply to your activity**.
- **Implications for the personalized response options:** If you engaged in a specific activity that you added to the options (e.g., playing tennis), please also select the broader response options that applied to the activity in that moment (e.g., response options "active leisure", "physical", and/ or "social").

In-person interaction: Just now, who were you interacting with in-person? Please select all that apply.

- Being around other people without any direct interaction (e.g., in a waiting room) does not count as in-person interaction.
- **You may interact with different people and thus can select multiple response options.** For example, when you are having dinner with your sister and your friend Lea, please select the options "family" and "friend(s)".
- However, please **only select a single response option per person** that best and most specifically describes their primary role in the interaction. For example, although you also have classes with Lea, please only select the option "friends" and *not* "classmate(s)" when you are having dinner with her as your friend.
- **Implications for personalized response options:** If you are interacting **only** with your roommate Marie, and you added "Marie" as a response option, select "Marie" only. However, if you're interacting with Marie **and** other roommates, select both "Marie" (for her specifically) and "roommates" (to capture your interaction with the other roommates).

Online interaction: Just now, what was your online interaction?

- Please select a **single response option that best and most specifically** describes the online interaction you engaged in just before filling out the survey. For example, although you may have been scrolling on social media for a long time and only started to make a post just before filling out the survey, please only select "Social media posting" and not "Social media reading/scrolling".
- **Implications for the personalized response options:** If you just created a post on Instagram and added "Instagram posting" to the response options, please only select this specific option ("Instagram posting") and not the broader category "Social media posting".

How to answer the question that asks about whether you had the opportunity to express certain behaviors?

- In the ESM surveys, we will ask you: *“Just now, did you have the opportunity to be either more or less ____ ? (please check all that apply)”*
- This question asks about **whether different behaviors were relevant** during the situation you were in just before filling out the ESM survey.
- A behavior is considered relevant whenever you have **the opportunity to express a higher or lower level** of that behavior. For example, you may generally have the opportunity to be either more or less sociable. In contrast, you may only have the opportunity to be either more or less flirtatious when you are around someone you are attracted to.